



Trump halts asylum, will deploy more troops

Orders place federal workers in bull's eye, on edge

BY EMILY DAVIES,
MATT VISER AND
MICHAEL BRICE-SADDLER

President Donald Trump targeted federal workers in an opening act aimed at exerting political control over a sprawling bureaucracy — putting federal diversity, equity and inclusion employees on leave, banning remote work and stripping employment protections from civil servants.

The moves, which came in rapid succession during Trump's first 48 hours as president, seek to fulfill a campaign pledge and a rallying cry among conservatives to crack down on programs that they consider unnecessary and exclusionary. DEI, the acronym for diversity, equity and inclusion that Trump uses in a derisive way, has long been a focus for some of his senior advisers such as Stephen Miller, now his deputy chief of staff.

Trump on Tuesday ordered all employees whose work is focused on DEI initiatives to be placed on leave no later than 5 p.m. Wednesday, and on Wednesday he revoked a 60-year-old executive order banning discrimination in hiring practices in the federal government. Some acting agency heads started enacting the guidance, with multiple directors Wednesday telling staff that all "DEIA offices" are closing and mandating employees report instances where government workers were trying to "disguise" programs by using "coded or precise language," according to emails obtained by The Washington Post. The White House did not respond to questions about how many of the 2.3 million federal employees were affected by his order.

Federal workers, meanwhile, are scrambling to make sense of the decrees, which may apply differently to each agency, depending on the person in charge and the fine print of union contracts. The return-to-office executive order in particular mystified employees and their supervisors, who are trying to parse whether it also affects telework, which is when employees who are based in an office work from home. The night Trump issued the executive order, Google searches for "federal workers return to office" spiked

SEE WORKERS ON A13

'DOGE': Disagreements with Musk prompted Ramaswamy's exit. A3



ANNA WATTS FOR THE WASHINGTON POST

Police attacked on Jan. 6 feel weary, betrayed

BY PETER HERMANN
AND ELLIE SILVERMAN

The calls kept coming.

"The defendant you testified against is being released from the Department of Corrections," the automated message said, according to former Capitol Police officer Harry Dunn.

Each of those defendants, Dunn said, assaulted his former colleague, Sgt. Aquilino Gonell, who sent him a screenshot of 10 calls from the Justice Department that began rolling in before the sun rose Tuesday, some just minutes apart.

Over the last four years, officers such as Dunn and Gonell had testified at trials and before congressional committees, at times facing the very people who made them fear for their lives on Jan. 6, 2021. They endured attacks with hammers, knives, bear spray and law enforcement's own shields as supporters of President Donald Trump stormed the U.S. Capitol. The officers believed it had be-

SEE POLICE ON A8



CHENEY ORR/REUTERS

FROM TOP: An asylum seeker in Ciudad Juarez, Mexico, reacts to the news this week that her appointment, and all further appointments, from the U.S. Customs and Border Protection app have been canceled. A National Guardsman in Eagle Pass, Texas, looks across the Rio Grande toward Mexico on Wednesday.

What happened on Wednesday

House Speaker Mike Johnson revealed a new committee to investigate the Capitol riot, part of a broader push to recast the events of Jan. 6, 2021.

National security adviser Michael Waltz ordered dozens of National Security Council officials sent home pending loyalty reviews. A5

The House passed the Laken Riley Act, which would allow the detention of undocumented immigrants accused of theft-related crimes. A6

Trump pardoned two D.C. police officers convicted of misconduct in the death of a Black man in 2020 that sparked a night of civil unrest. B1

Officials who defy deportation effort will be DOJ targets

BY MARIA SACCHETTI
AND JEREMY ROEBUCK

The Trump administration has directed federal prosecutors nationwide to investigate and potentially bring criminal charges against state and local officials who don't cooperate with the president's plans to carry out mass deportations, according to a document obtained by The Washington Post.

In a memo to Justice Department employees late Tuesday, acting deputy attorney general Emil Bove wrote that the supremacy clause of the Constitution and other legal authorities "require state and local actors to comply with the Executive Branch's immigration enforcement initiatives."

He ordered U.S. attorneys' offices across the country to investigate any official who defies those efforts and consider prosecuting them on charges that, if they're convicted, could send them to prison.

"Federal law prohibits state and

SEE IMMIGRATION ON A4

EMERGENCY POWERS INVOKED AT BORDER

'Just the beginning,' acting defense chief says

BY NICK MIROFF,
DAN LAMOTHE,
MARIA SACCHETTI
AND MARIANNE LEVINE

President Donald Trump is preparing to send around 10,000 troops to the southern border, where they will support Border Patrol agents under new orders to shut off access to asylum, according to a U.S. Customs and Border Protection briefing document obtained by The Washington Post.

The order directs border agents to block entry to migrants on the grounds that they have passed through countries where communicable diseases are present, without citing any specific health threat.

The Defense Department will send at least 1,500 additional active-duty ground troops to the southern border in what could be the first of several waves of deployments, said acting defense secretary Robert Salesses. Those forces will bolster about 2,500 who already were there. Other active-duty troops will pilot military planes to assist the Department of Homeland Security in deporting migrants who already are in detention, with DHS providing law enforcement on those flights, Salesses said.

"This is just the beginning," he said in a statement Wednesday evening.

The CBP briefing, delivered Tuesday to senior staff at the agency's headquarters in Washington by newly appointed Border Patrol Chief Mike Banks, instructs U.S. agents to use an extraordinary emergency authority to close the border. The only two Border Patrol officials who can authorize the release of an asylum seeker into the United States with a pending humanitarian claim are Banks and his deputy.

The briefing document is an early glimpse into the real-world application of the fusillade of executive orders Trump issued Monday, and their translation into field guidance for the Border Patrol's 19,000 agents. The White House did not immediately respond to a request for comment.

During the coronavirus pandemic

SEE BORDER ON A6

Justice Department: Cases in the civil rights division are frozen. A5

'Scary Terry' McLaurin has plenty of reasons to celebrate

Never one to showboat, Commanders star debuts pair of signature moves

BY SAM FORTIER

For months, teammates had been giving Washington Commanders star wide receiver Terry McLaurin a hard time because he did not have a signature celebration.

They were confused. NFL wideouts have a long, rich history of iconic "cellys," as players call them, including Chad Johnson's prop-filled antics, Jaylen Waddle's waddle and Justin Jefferson's Griddy. How could McLaurin — whom Washington fans adore and chant for when he takes the field or catches a pass — not have one by his sixth season? "He's got to do something,"

cornerback Michael Davis remembered thinking.

Days after Halloween, "Scary Terry," as he's affectionately called, caught two touchdown passes against the New York Giants, which turned out to be a fortunate coincidence.

The man with no celebrations suddenly had two.

McLaurin is not a natural showman. Growing up in Indianapolis, he wore short shorts instead of fashionably baggy clothes because, according to friends, he cared about being a good athlete far more than looking cool.

"No signature celebrations," Dominique Booth, his former high school quarterback, wrote in a text message. "We didn't showboat much if at all when we were younger."

SEE COMMANDERS ON A8

'He's a star': Commanders rookie Sainristil has come into his own. D1

Decades after her abuse, a call leads to a confession

BY EMMA UBER

For 44 years, she had thought about making the call. She had waited for her parents to die. She had waited for her children to grow up. She had waited until she found other victims and researched whether it was normal for people in her position to wait.

On June 7, she warned her two daughters, who were home from college. Her son was away working a summer job. The girls encouraged her to call, but still she waited until they left for the day.

Finally, she was alone. It felt fitting to handle things the same way she'd carried her secret for years.

Seated on the secluded deck of her Fairfax County, Virginia, home with a coffee in hand, she dialed the number for Fairfax County police.

There was nothing special about this Friday in June. It was just time, she thought. The idea, a whisper in the back of her mind for decades, had crescendoed in

After carrying her secret since age 11, she says, coming forward to make a report was 'cathartic'



ROBB HILL FOR THE WASHINGTON POST

Stephanie came forward about childhood sexual abuse that spanned years at a barn in Great Falls, Virginia.

recent years when a childhood friend who was dying revealed that she, too, shared this secret.

She had long doubted her story would be enough.

A corporate lawyer, she worried she would need a "critical mass" of survivors to come forward to build a case. Besides, she said, she feared authorities might find the arc of her life disqualifying in a case without physical evidence. She hadn't encountered the addiction or depression so common among survivors. Instead, she had finished high school, gone off to college, earned multiple degrees, graduated from an elite law school, launched a successful career and raised a family with the support of her loving parents.

"Maybe they'll catch this guy, maybe they'll laugh," she remembers thinking. "But I gotta say something."

She pressed the green call button. Almost immediately, someone picked up.

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IN THE NEWS

Royal deal Prince Harry settled his phone-hacking case against Rupert Murdoch's British tabloids for an eight-figure sum and a "full and unequivocal apology." A10

The big chill The Arctic blast gripping the Washington region is the coldest streak of weather since 2018. B1

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